

SelAction: how selection response and inbreeding are predicted

A guide and mathematical specification of the `fortran/` source

Source-based report for `fortran/`

2 October 2026

Abstract

SelAction predicts what a livestock breeding program will achieve: how fast the breeding goal improves (the response to selection) and how fast inbreeding accumulates. This report explains, first in plain language and then precisely, how the program computes those predictions. It covers the genetic covariance model, the information sources available on each candidate (own records, relatives, progeny and BLUP breeding values), the selection index, selection intensity with family structure, the iteration to equilibrium that accounts for the loss of variance under selection (the Bulmer effect), one- to three-stage selection with discrete generations, prediction of the rate of inbreeding, and selection across age classes with overlapping generations. Every equation is tied to the routine that implements it. Where the code departs from the clean mathematics, or contains a known defect, this is stated explicitly. The report is written for two audiences: graduate students and users who want to understand what SelAction does, and developers who need to reproduce or port it.

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1 Introduction

SelAction was described by Rutten, Bijma, Woolliams and van Arendonk [14]. Given a description of a breeding program (traits, genetic parameters, numbers of parents and offspring, available information) it predicts, deterministically and in seconds, the long-term response to selection and the rate of inbreeding. No simulation is involved: everything follows from selection-index theory and the theory of long-term genetic contributions.

How to read this report.

- *If you are new to the topic*, read Section 2 first. It explains the six ideas the program is built on, with figures and references to the original papers. The “In words” box at the start of each later section summarises that section without equations.
- *If you want the equations*, Section 3 lists every symbol, and Sections 4–7 give the model in the order the program computes it.
- *If you are porting or checking the code*, the orange “Implementation note” boxes, the source map in Section 8, the list of known issues in Section 9 and the appendices give the details needed for exact numerical agreement.

Scope. The source of record is `seldiscrete.f90`, `selovlp.f90`, `selroutines.f90` and `seltools.f90` in `fortran/` (called `fortran_mac/` before 5 October 2026), as of the date above. Changes to the code are recorded in `NEWS.md` at the top of the repository. Input/output formatting is outside scope.

2 Key ideas for new readers

2.1 The breeding goal and the selection index

A breeding program aims to improve several traits at once, each with an economic value. The *breeding goal* (or aggregate genotype) is the economically weighted sum of the true breeding values of an animal, $H = \sum_a v_a A_a$. True breeding values cannot be observed. What can be observed are phenotypes of the animal and of its relatives. A *selection index* I is the linear combination of these observations that predicts H as well as possible: its weights are chosen to maximise the correlation between I and H [10]. That correlation is the *accuracy* r_{IH} . SelAction builds one such index for each sex (and for each stage or age class).

2.2 Information sources and BLUP

Figure 1 shows the information SelAction can use for one candidate: its own performance, the means of groups of full sibs, paternal half sibs and progeny, and estimated breeding values (EBVs) of its parents. In practice, animals are selected on BLUP breeding values computed with an animal model and the whole pedigree. SelAction does not run BLUP. Instead it adds the EBVs of the sire, the dam, and the mates of the sire to the index. Wray and Hill [18] used this parent-EBV index to approximate response to animal-model BLUP selection; Dekkers [6] separately analysed asymptotic response to BLUP selection under the Bulmer effect. Villanueva, Wray and Thompson [16] extended the index approach to multiple traits, the setting relevant to SelAction. Bijma and van Arendonk [1] applied a related multitrait pseudo-BLUP index to purebred and crossbred information. Each source has a numeric code that appears in the input file and in the program output.

Information sources for one selection candidate

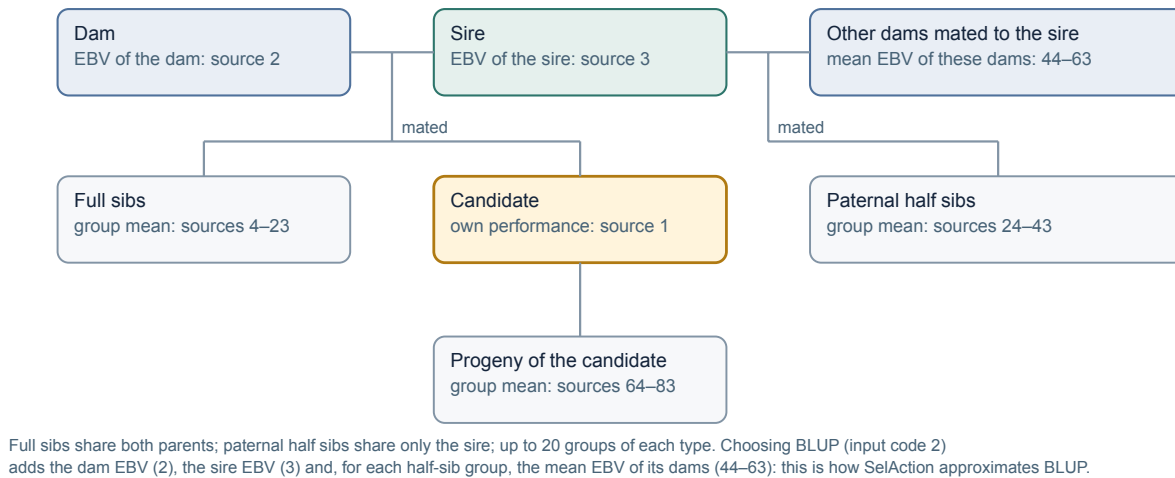


Figure 1: Information sources for one selection candidate and their source numbers (Section 4.2). Editable SVG source: `selection_sources.svg`.

2.3 Truncation selection and selection intensity

Candidates are ranked on their index and the best fraction p is kept. If the index is normally distributed this is *truncation selection*: everyone above a threshold t is selected (Figure 2). The

mean of the selected animals, in standard deviations of the index, is the *selection intensity* i . The response in the breeding goal per generation is then intensity $\times$ accuracy $\times$ the standard deviation of H , which equals $i\sqrt{V_I}$ when written with the index variance V_I . Selection also makes the selected group less variable than the candidates: their variance shrinks by a fraction k (Figure 2).

Truncation selection: the best fraction p of candidates is kept

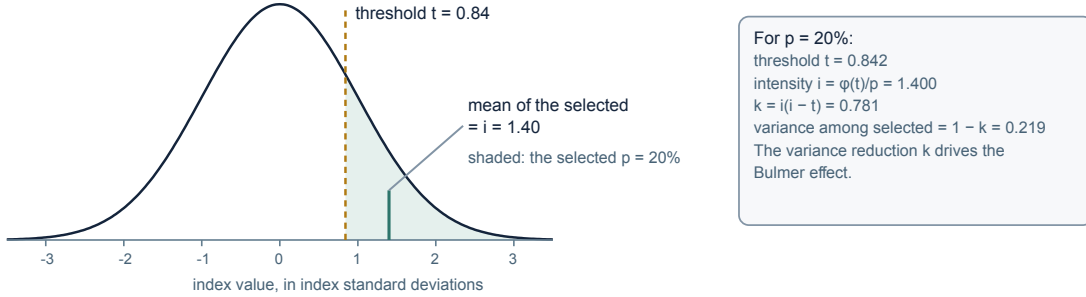


Figure 2: Truncation selection on a standardised index, worked through for $p = 20\%$. The intensity i is the mean of the selected; k is the proportional loss of variance among them (Eq. 10). Editable SVG source: `selection_truncation.svg`.

2.4 Family structure lowers the intensity

The formula $i = \phi(t)/p$ describes truncation at a fixed threshold in a normal population. When a fixed number is selected from a finite set of related candidates, full and half sibs share information (and indices that use family means give sibs very similar scores), so selected animals cluster in the best families. This can reduce the realised selection differential, especially in small populations [13, 12]. SelAction uses an approximation based on these papers (routine `raw13`, Appendix B) that adjusts i according to family sizes and the correlation of index values within full- and half-sib families. This correction is applied with discrete generations; under overlapping generations it is computed but not used (Section 7).

2.5 The Bulmer effect and equilibrium

Selecting parents with high index values creates negative correlations (linkage disequilibrium) between the genes they carry, which reduces the genetic variance between families in the next generation [5]. After a few generations of the same selection the variance settles at a lower equilibrium, and so do the accuracy and the response. Predictions based on the unselected (base) population overstate long-term response; asymptotic responses can be up to a quarter lower [18, 6]. SelAction therefore repeats the cycle of “build the index, select, update the variances” 25 times and reports the result (Figure 3).

2.6 Discrete versus overlapping generations, and multiple stages

With *discrete generations*, all parents are replaced every generation, and selection can be done in up to three stages (for example on own performance first, then on BLUP after more records are available). With *overlapping generations*, animals of several ages are available and compete for the same places; younger animals are genetically better on average (they are later products of selection)

Selection reduces variance, so SelAction iterates to equilibrium (Bulmer effect)

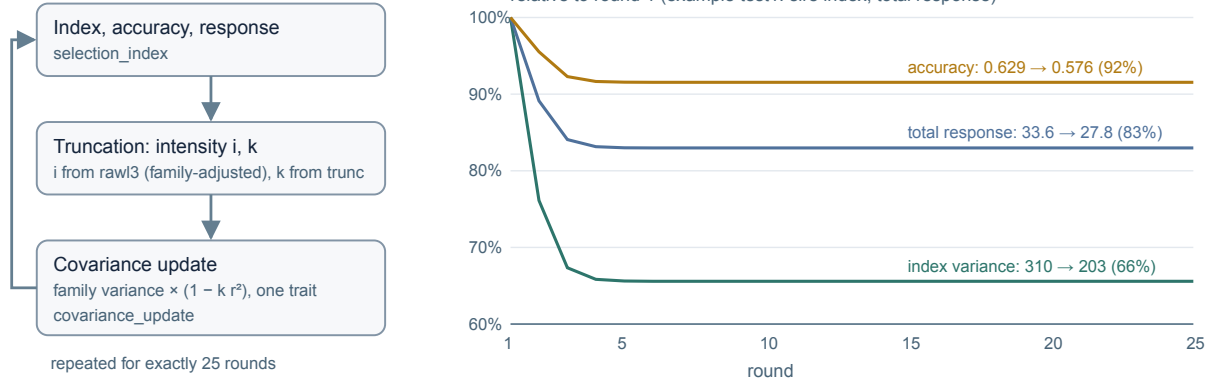


Figure 3: The 25-round iteration (left) and how the example `test1` in the regression tests converges (right): the variance of the sire index falls from 310 to 203, its accuracy from 0.629 to 0.576, and the total response from 33.6 to 27.8 economic units, with the values settled after about six rounds. Values recorded from the program while it ran. Editable SVG source: `selaction_bulmer.svg`.

while older animals may have more information. SelAction then applies one threshold to all age classes of a sex (Section 7), which also determines the generation interval and the response per year.

2.7 Rate of inbreeding

Inbreeding accumulates because selected parents leave unequal numbers of descendants. The rate of inbreeding ΔF can be predicted from the expected long-term genetic contributions of individuals, which depend on their selective advantage [19]. Woolliams and Bijma [17] developed the general contribution framework, and Bijma, van Arendonk and Woolliams [2] gave a procedure for mass selection. SelAction uses a multitrait version of the more specific predictions for BLUP selection of Bijma and Woolliams [4], with a correction for finite family sizes. It is computed for one-stage selection with discrete generations only.

3 Notation and computational structure

In words

This section lists every symbol used in the rest of the report. Bold lower-case letters are vectors (one entry per trait or per information source), bold capitals are matrices. The program keeps separate copies of most quantities for sires and dams.

Indices: traits $a, b = 1, \dots, T$; sex $g \in \{s, d\}$ (sire or dam); selection stage $j = 1, 2, 3$; age class $c = 1, \dots, K$. All variables are centred within the relevant candidate group; superscript T denotes transpose. A cross-covariance matrix need not be symmetric.

Table 1: Symbols used in this report and the corresponding names in the Fortran source.

Symbol	Meaning	Source name
<i>Breeding goal</i>		
$\mathbf{A}$	vector of true additive genetic (breeding) values, one per trait	–
$\mathbf{v}$	economic values; zero for traits not in the goal	tempev
H, σ_H^2	breeding goal $H = \mathbf{v}^\top \mathbf{A}$ and its variance	sigmah
<i>Variance components (per trait a) and covariance matrices</i>		
$V_{P,a}, h_a^2, c_a^2$	phenotypic variance, heritability, common-environment fraction	sigmap, hh, cc
$\mathbf{A}$	additive genetic covariance matrix of candidates	covapaq
$\mathbf{A}_s, \mathbf{A}_d, \mathbf{A}_w$	parts of $\mathbf{A}$ due to the sire, the dam, and within-family (Mendelian) variation; $\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{A}_s + \mathbf{A}_d + \mathbf{A}_w$	covas, covad, covaw
$\mathbf{P}, \mathbf{C}, \mathbf{E}$	phenotypic, common-environment (full sibs) and residual covariance matrices	covp, covc, cove
$\mathbf{C}_{\text{prog}}$	common environment within a progeny group	covcprog
$\mathbf{F}, \mathbf{J}$	phenotypic covariance between full sibs and between paternal half sibs	fs, hs
$\mathbf{S}, \mathbf{D}$	covariance matrices of sire EBVs and dam EBVs	s, d
$\mathbf{R}_A, \mathbf{R}_P, \mathbf{R}_C$	genetic, phenotypic, common-environment correlation matrices	gcorr, phcorr, ccorr
<i>Selection index</i>		
$\mathbf{x}$	vector of the information sources in the index	–
$\mathbf{P}_x, \mathbf{G}$	$\text{Var}(\mathbf{x})$ and $\text{Cov}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{A})$	invp (inverse), realg
$\mathbf{b}, I$	index weights and index $I = \mathbf{b}^\top \mathbf{x}$	b
V_I, r_{IH}	index variance and accuracy	sigmai, rih
$\mathbf{q}$	$\text{Cov}(\mathbf{A}, I) = \mathbf{G}^\top \mathbf{b}$	covapi
<i>Truncation selection</i>		
p, t	fraction selected and standardised threshold	pval
i, k	selection intensity and variance-reduction factor	i/is, k/ks
i_{eff}	intensity corrected for family structure (raw13)	ii
ρ_{fs}, ρ_{hs}	correlation of index values of full sibs and of half sibs	corrfs, corrhs
$\phi, \Phi, \bar{\Phi}$	standard normal density, distribution function, and upper tail $1 - \Phi$	–
<i>Population structure</i>		
M_s, M_d	numbers of selected sires and dams	nsires, ndams
d	mating ratio M_d/M_s (dams per sire)	neffdams
n_m, n_f	male and female candidates per dam	noffs, noffd
$n_{F,u}, n_{H,u}, m_{H,u}$	full-sib group size; half-sib group size and its number of dams	fsgroupsoff, hsgroupsoff, hsgroups dams

Symbol	Meaning	Source name
$n_{Q,u}, m_{Q,u}$	progeny group size and number of dams	proggroupsoff*, proggroupsdams
<i>Multistage selection</i>		
$p_{g,j}, P_{g,j}$	fraction passing stage j , and cumulative fraction $\prod_{\ell \leq j} p_{g,\ell}$	pvals, pvals2
$r_{g,j\ell}$	correlation between the stage- j and stage- ℓ indices	dumcorrsrih*
<i>Overlapping generations</i>		
$N_{g,c}, n_{g,c}$	candidates and selected animals in age class c	nanim, nselec
$w_{g,c}$	share of the selected parents of sex g coming from class c	—
x_g	common threshold for sex g across age classes	zriddr
L_g, L	generation interval of a sex, and their average	genints, genintd
<i>Inbreeding</i>		
ΔF	rate of inbreeding per generation	delf
$\mathbf{\Gamma}_{gq}$	covariance between information and selective advantage (Eq. 20)	Cmm, Cmf, ...
Λ, Π	2×2 matrices of the contribution model	glambda, gpi
κ_{uv}	conditional-to-unconditional selection ratios (Eq. 23)	—

Two letters have a second, unrelated use: F in ΔF (inbreeding) is not the matrix $\mathbf{F}$, and the subscripts s, d denote sex, not the matrices $\mathbf{S}, \mathbf{D}$.

Each trait may enter the index, the goal, both, or neither (input flags **i**, **h**, **b**, **n**). The aggregate genotype is

$$H = \mathbf{v}^\top \mathbf{A}, \quad \sigma_H^2 = \mathbf{v}^\top \mathbf{A} \mathbf{v}, \quad \mathbf{A} = \text{Var}(\mathbf{A}). \quad (1)$$

Sire and dam indices can differ. Figure 4 shows the order of the calculations.

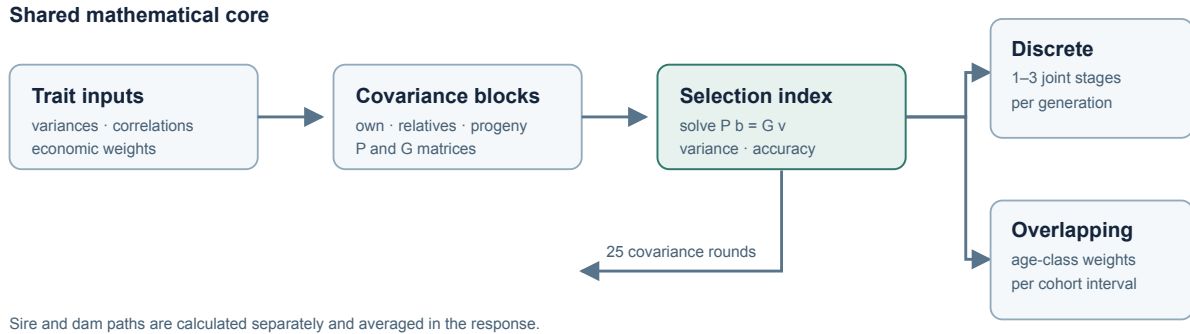


Figure 4: Shared covariance and index calculations feed the discrete and age-structured schemes. Editable SVG source: `selection_flow.svg`.

4 Covariance model and information vector

In words

Each trait’s phenotype is split into a genetic part, a common-environment part shared by full sibs, and a residual. The genetic part is further split into what comes from the sire, from the dam, and from Mendelian sampling. From these pieces the program builds the covariance between every pair of information sources (for example “own record” and “mean of the half sibs”), and between each source and the true breeding values.

4.1 Starting components

For trait a , the inputs are the phenotypic variance $V_{P,a}$, heritability h_a^2 , and common-environment fraction c_a^2 . The code initialises

$$\begin{aligned} V_{A,a} &= h_a^2 V_{P,a}, & V_{C,a} &= c_a^2 V_{P,a}, & V_{E,a} &= V_{P,a} - V_{A,a} - V_{C,a}, \\ V_{A_s,a} &= V_{A_d,a} = \frac{1}{4} V_{A,a}, & V_{A_w,a} &= \frac{1}{2} V_{A,a}. \end{aligned} \quad (2)$$

Given genetic, phenotypic and common-environment correlation matrices $\mathbf{R}_A, \mathbf{R}_P, \mathbf{R}_C$, the initial covariance matrices are

$$\begin{aligned} A_{ab} &= R_{A,ab} \sqrt{V_{A,a} V_{A,b}}, & P_{ab} &= R_{P,ab} \sqrt{V_{P,a} V_{P,b}}, \\ (A_s)_{ab} &= \frac{1}{4} A_{ab}, & (A_d)_{ab} &= \frac{1}{4} A_{ab}, & (A_w)_{ab} &= \frac{1}{2} A_{ab}, \\ C_{ab} &= R_{C,ab} \sqrt{V_{C,a} V_{C,b}}, & E_{ab} &= P_{ab} - A_{ab} - C_{ab}. \end{aligned} \quad (3)$$

For a progeny-test common-environment fraction $c_{\text{prog},a}^2$, the same rule gives

$$C_{\text{prog},ab} = R_{C,ab} \sqrt{c_{\text{prog},a}^2 V_{P,a} c_{\text{prog},b}^2 V_{P,b}}. \quad (4)$$

The source computes an intermediate residual correlation and reconstructs $\mathbf{E}$ from it; this equals $\mathbf{P} - \mathbf{A} - \mathbf{C}$ whenever its denominators are nonzero. At every discrete covariance update the matrices are reassembled as

$$\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{A}_s + \mathbf{A}_d + \mathbf{A}_w, \quad \mathbf{P} = \mathbf{A} + \mathbf{C} + \mathbf{E}, \quad \mathbf{F} = \mathbf{A}_s + \mathbf{A}_d + \mathbf{C}, \quad \mathbf{J} = \mathbf{A}_s. \quad (5)$$

$\mathbf{F}$ and $\mathbf{J}$ are the phenotypic covariances between full sibs and between paternal half sibs.

4.2 Information sources and the index covariance

Internally, each indexed trait may have: own phenotype (source 1), dam EBV (2), sire EBV (3), up to 20 full-sib group means (4–23), 20 paternal-half-sib group means (24–43), 20 means of the EBVs of the dams in each half-sib group (44–63), and 20 progeny group means (64–83). The observation vector $\mathbf{x}$ contains only the trait–source pairs actually selected. The routines `info_sources*` create that ordered list (sorted by source number), and `selection_index` picks the corresponding rows and columns out of a table covering all 83 sources for every trait pair.

Implementation note

These are internal source numbers, not exactly what the user types. Entering code 2 (“BLUP breeding values”) adds both source 2 and source 3, and for every half-sib group 24...43 selected it adds the matching dam-EBV source (group number +20, i.e. 44–63). In discrete selection, if $M_s = M_d$ (each sire has one dam, so there are no paternal half sibs) sources 24–63 are removed from the final-stage source list (Section 9 notes that earlier-stage lists are not filtered).

Write $\mathbf{P}_x = \text{Var}(\mathbf{x})$ and $\mathbf{G} = \text{Cov}(\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{A})$. For a source measuring trait a , the entries of $\mathbf{G}$ in the column of the true value A_b are:

Source	$G_{(a,u),b}$
Own phenotype	A_{ab}
Dam EBV	$D_{ba}/2$
Sire EBV	$S_{ba}/2$
Full-sib mean	$(A_s + A_d)_{ab}$
Paternal-half-sib mean	$(A_s)_{ab}$
Mean dam EBV	0
Progeny mean	$A_{ab}/2$

$\mathbf{S}$ and $\mathbf{D}$ are the current sire- and dam-EBV covariance matrices; the transposed trait indices follow the `matg` assignments in the code. Every trait has a column of $\mathbf{G}$, whether or not it is in the goal; only index traits have rows. In $\mathbf{P}_x$, by contrast, a block for a pair of sources has (a, b) entry with a the trait of the first-listed source and b that of the second, so for example $\text{Cov}(O_a, B_{d,b}) = D_{ab}/2$. The distinction matters because $\mathbf{S}$ and $\mathbf{D}$ need not be exactly symmetric (Section 5.3).

Family sizes enter $\mathbf{P}_x$ explicitly. For full-sib group u of $n_{F,u}$ offspring, half-sib group u of $n_{H,u}$ offspring from $m_{H,u}$ dams, and a progeny group u of $n_{Q,u}$ offspring from $m_{Q,u}$ dams:

$$\begin{aligned}
\text{Var}(\bar{\mathbf{x}}_{F,u}) &= \mathbf{A}_s + \mathbf{A}_d + \mathbf{C} + (\mathbf{A}_w + \mathbf{E})/n_{F,u}, \\
\text{Var}(\bar{\mathbf{x}}_{H,u}) &= \mathbf{A}_s + (\mathbf{A}_d + \mathbf{C})/m_{H,u} + (\mathbf{A}_w + \mathbf{E})/n_{H,u}, \\
\text{Var}(\bar{\mathbf{x}}_{Q,u} \mid \text{sire candidate}) &= \frac{1}{4}\mathbf{A} + (\frac{1}{4}\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{C}_{\text{prog}})/m_{Q,u} + (\mathbf{A}_w + \mathbf{E})/n_{Q,u}, \\
\text{Var}(\bar{\mathbf{x}}_{Q,u} \mid \text{dam candidate}) &= \frac{1}{2}\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{C}_{\text{prog}} + (\mathbf{A}_w + \mathbf{E})/n_{Q,u}^{(d)}.
\end{aligned} \tag{6}$$

Here $n_{Q,u}^{(d)} = n_{Q,u}/m_{Q,u}$ is the number of progeny per dam (`proggroupsoffd`): a dam candidate's progeny group is a single full-sib family. Different full-sib groups have covariance $\mathbf{F}$ and different half-sib groups have covariance $\mathbf{J}$. Within the same half-sib group, $\text{Cov}(\bar{\mathbf{x}}_{H,u}, \bar{\text{EBV}}_{d,u}) = \mathbf{D}/(2m_{H,u})$ and $\text{Var}(\bar{\text{EBV}}_{d,u}) = \mathbf{D}/m_{H,u}$. All other pairs of sources are listed in Appendix A. A port should build the full block table before selecting rows: group means are correlated observations, not independent errors.

5 Shared selection equations

In words

The routines in this section are used by every selection scheme. They compute the best index from the covariances, the expected response for a given intensity, the intensity itself (corrected for family structure), and how one round of selection changes the variances. Repeating the last step 25 times gives the equilibrium.

5.1 Index, accuracy and response

The common `selection_index` routine calculates

$$\mathbf{P}_x \mathbf{b} = \mathbf{G} \mathbf{v}, \quad I = \mathbf{b}^\top \mathbf{x}, \quad V_I = \mathbf{b}^\top \mathbf{P}_x \mathbf{b}, \quad r_{IH} = \sqrt{V_I / \sigma_H^2}. \tag{7}$$

The source builds $\mathbf{P}_x$ in single precision, inverts it explicitly by Gauss–Jordan elimination in double precision (`invrt`, stopping if a pivot falls below 10^{-12}), and stores and uses the inverse in single precision; a new implementation should solve the linear system instead. With $\mathbf{q} = \mathbf{G}^\top \mathbf{b} = \text{Cov}(\mathbf{A}, I)$ and effective standardised selection differential i_{eff} ,

$$\Delta \mathbf{A} = i_{\text{eff}} \frac{\mathbf{q}}{\sqrt{V_I}}, \quad \Delta H = i_{\text{eff}} \sqrt{V_I}. \quad (8)$$

The second equality follows from the optimal weights. One-stage discrete-generation response is the average of the sire and dam paths:

$$\Delta \mathbf{A}_{\text{gen}} = \frac{1}{2}(\Delta \mathbf{A}_s + \Delta \mathbf{A}_d), \quad \Delta H_{\text{gen}} = \frac{1}{2}(\Delta H_s + \Delta H_d). \quad (9)$$

Implementation note

If V_I comes out negative (possible in the first round, before the iteration settles), r_{IH} and the responses are set to zero for that round instead of taking a square root of a negative number. The correlations ρ_{fs}, ρ_{hs} of Eq. (11) are still computed with the negative V_I . `selection_index` always calls `rawl3` for i_{eff} , whatever the calling scheme; the multistage and overlapping drivers override or discard that value (Sections 6–7).

5.2 Truncation and related candidates

For upper-tail fraction p , let $t = \Phi^{-1}(1 - p)$ and $z = \phi(t)$. The common `trunc` routine returns

$$i = z/p, \quad k = i(i - t), \quad \text{Var}(Z \mid Z > t) = 1 - k. \quad (10)$$

`trunc` stops with an error if p lies outside $[0, 1]$ (the endpoints pass; $p = 0$ gives an infinite i). The threshold t comes from `gcef`, the rational approximation 26.2.23 of Abramowitz and Stegun (absolute error below 4.5×10^{-4}), with $t = -7$ returned for $p = 1$ and $t = 7$ for $p < 10^{-10}$, so t differs slightly from an exact Φ^{-1} ; exact reproduction needs `gcef` itself.

The discrete one-stage response replaces i in Eq. (8) by the family-adjusted i_{eff} from `rawl3`. Its arguments are $(p, n_w, n_{fs}, n_{hs}, \rho_{fs}, \rho_{hs})$: candidates of that sex per full-sib family (n_m or n_f), full-sib families per paternal-half-sib family (d), paternal-half-sib families (M_s), and the two intraclass correlations of index values

$$\rho_{fs} = \frac{\mathbf{b}^\top \mathbf{R}_{fs} \mathbf{b}}{V_I}, \quad \rho_{hs} = \frac{\mathbf{b}^\top \mathbf{R}_{hs} \mathbf{b}}{V_I}. \quad (11)$$

$\mathbf{R}_{fs}$ and $\mathbf{R}_{hs}$ are covariance matrices between the information vectors of two full sibs and of two half sibs. They are built from the same source types as $\mathbf{P}_x$ but include extra finite-sampling terms (mostly divided by the summed group sizes, a few by the size of the group itself); they are not tabulated in this report. The code clips each correlation to $[-1, 1]$. `rawl3` is an empirical approximation based on Rawlings [13] and Meuwissen [12], with finite-population branches and interpolation; it is not simply $\phi(t)/p$. Appendix B gives its equations.

5.3 Bulmer update

Let $\mathbf{Q} = \mathbf{G}^\top \mathbf{P}_x^{-1} \mathbf{G}$ and $\mathbf{q} = \mathbf{G}^\top \mathbf{b}$. For each sex g , `covariance_update` has the matrix form

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{A}_g^{\text{family, new}} &= \frac{1}{4} \left(\mathbf{A} - \frac{k_g}{V_{I,g}} \mathbf{q}_g \mathbf{q}_g^\top \right), \\ \mathbf{S}_g^{\text{new}} &= \mathbf{Q}_g - \frac{k_g}{V_{I,g}} \mathbf{q}_g \mathbf{u}_g^\top, \quad \mathbf{u}_g = \mathbf{G}_g^\top \mathbf{P}_{x,g}^{-1} \mathbf{G}_g \mathbf{v}. \end{aligned} \quad (12)$$

$\mathbf{A}_g^{\text{family}}$ is $\mathbf{A}_s$ or $\mathbf{A}_d$, and $\mathbf{S}_g$ is the corresponding sire or dam EBV covariance ($\mathbf{S}$ or $\mathbf{D}$). Both sexes use the same, old $\mathbf{A}$. In exact arithmetic $\mathbf{u}_g = \mathbf{q}_g$, but the source evaluates the products separately, so $\mathbf{S}_g$ need not be exactly symmetric. After both sexes, Eq. (5) rebuilds $\mathbf{A}, \mathbf{P}, \mathbf{F}, \mathbf{J}$. The within-family additive covariance $\mathbf{A}_w$, common environment $\mathbf{C}$, and residual $\mathbf{E}$ never change. For a single trait the update reads $V_{A_g}^{\text{new}} = \frac{1}{4}V_A(1 - k_g r_{IH}^2)$: the between-family variance shrinks in proportion to the intensity of selection and the accuracy.

Implementation note

The driver executes exactly 25 rounds with no convergence test. The reported r_{IH} , V_I and responses come from the 25th call of `selection_index`, i.e. after 24 updates; the 25th update only affects the printed covariances and the inbreeding calculation. k_g comes once from `trunc` at the input fraction and is *not* family-adjusted; only the intensity used for response goes through `rawl3`. The starting $\mathbf{S}, \mathbf{D}$ are a simplified form built with a diagonal approximation of the index variance, $V_{I,g}^{(0)} = (1 - k_g) \sum_a h_a^2 V_{A,a} v_a^2$ over goal traits; this value is used only there, since the first call of `selection_index` computes $V_I = \mathbf{b}^\top \mathbf{P}_x \mathbf{b}$ itself. The starting $\mathbf{A}_s = \mathbf{A}_d = \frac{1}{4}\mathbf{A}$ are not reduced for selection.

6 Discrete generations

In words

With discrete generations, all parents are replaced every generation. In one-stage selection the program iterates the shared equations of Section 5 and also predicts the rate of inbreeding. In two- or three-stage selection, candidates must pass successive thresholds on successively better indices; because the indices are correlated, the program works with the joint (multivariate normal) distribution of the stage indices.

6.1 One stage

`sel1s` builds the sire and dam source lists, initialises Eq. (2), obtains k_s, k_d from Eq. (10), and iterates `selection_index` plus `covariance_update` for 25 rounds. Equations (8)–(9) then give the final trait and goal responses, and `dFmtblup` the rate of inbreeding (Section 6.3).

6.2 Two and three stages: joint selection

Let $p_{g,j}$ be the fraction passing stage j among the candidates entering it and $P_{g,j} = \prod_{\ell=1}^j p_{g,\ell}$ the cumulative fraction. Each stage has its own index from Eq. (7), with more information sources in later stages. The code runs the 25 covariance rounds on the final-stage index, then re-evaluates the earlier-stage indices on the resulting matrices.

Implementation note

During the 25 rounds, k_g comes from `trunc` at the cumulative fraction $P_{g,m}$: the equilibrium treats the scheme as single-stage truncation on the final index. The multistage structure is not fed back into the covariance update.

For nested indices the source uses the ratio of accuracies as the correlation between stage indices

(exact for nested optimal indices), capped at 0.93:

$$r_{g,j\ell} = r_{IH,g,j}/r_{IH,g,\ell} \quad (j < \ell), \quad r_{g,j\ell} \leftarrow \min(r_{g,j\ell}, 0.93). \quad (13)$$

Let $\mathbf{Z} = (Z_1, \dots, Z_m)$ be the standardised stage indices with correlation matrix $\mathbf{R}_g$. The thresholds $t_1, \dots, t_m$ satisfy successive joint-tail probabilities

$$\Pr(Z_1 > t_1) = P_{g,1}, \quad \Pr(Z_1 > t_1, Z_2 > t_2) = P_{g,2}, \quad \Pr(Z_1 > t_1, Z_2 > t_2, Z_3 > t_3) = P_{g,3}, \quad (14)$$

of which only the first m apply. Figure 5 shows the idea: the final selected set is the intersection of the passing sets.

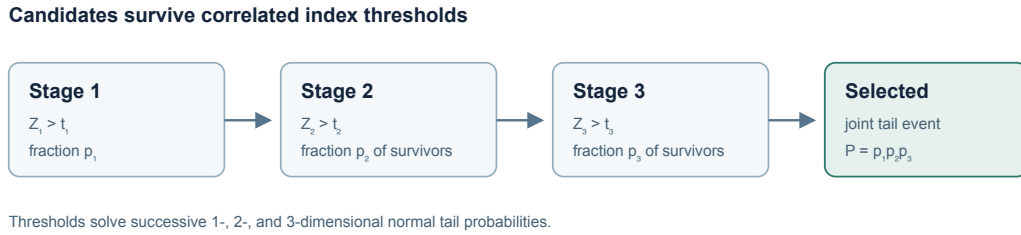


Figure 5: Conditional survival across stages; the final selected set is the intersection of all stage-tail events. Editable SVG source: `selection_stages.svg`.

Implementation note

The thresholds are found by Newton iteration in `sseuil1/2/3` (at most 20 steps, absolute tolerance 10^{-5} on the probability), using the general multivariate-normal routine `sdutt`. Its integral-transform approach follows Dutt [9] as applied to quantitative genetics by Ducrocq and Colleau [7]. `sdutt` uses 10-point Gauss–Hermite quadrature, or an adaptive loop over 10 to 30 points when a threshold exceeds 2 in absolute value or a correlation exceeds 0.5; tails beyond 4–5 standard deviations are set to 0 or 1. If the tolerance has not been reached after 20 steps a warning is printed (screen and output file) and the last threshold is kept; the original failure test checked for 50 iterations and never fired. (In the original code the tables stopped at 20 points, so the adaptive loop could silently return 0.25 or 0.125 for small fractions and high stage correlations; see `NEWS.md`.) In the boundary terms below, one-dimensional tails come from `sdutt1` (via `erfc`) and two-dimensional tails from `sdutt2` with 20 points.

The quantity of interest is the vector of mean stage indices among the finally selected, $\boldsymbol{\mu}_I = \mathbb{E}[\mathbf{I} \mid Z_j > t_j \text{ for all } j]$. For two stages, with correlation r and cumulative fraction $P = P_{g,2}$, define

$$B_1 = \phi(t_1)\bar{\Phi}\left(\frac{t_2 - rt_1}{\sqrt{1-r^2}}\right), \quad B_2 = \phi(t_2)\bar{\Phi}\left(\frac{t_1 - rt_2}{\sqrt{1-r^2}}\right). \quad (15)$$

The implemented means are

$$\mu_{I,1} = \frac{\sqrt{V_{I,1}}}{P}(B_1 + rB_2), \quad \mu_{I,2} = \frac{\sqrt{V_{I,2}}}{P}(rB_1 + B_2). \quad (16)$$

For three stages let $B_j = \phi(t_j) \Pr(Z_{-j} > \mathbf{t}_{-j} \mid Z_j = t_j)$. The two-dimensional conditional tail uses

$$t_{\ell|j} = \frac{t_\ell - r_{j\ell}t_j}{\sqrt{1-r_{j\ell}^2}}, \quad r_{\ell k|j} = \frac{r_{\ell k} - r_{j\ell}r_{jk}}{\sqrt{(1-r_{j\ell}^2)(1-r_{jk}^2)}}. \quad (17)$$

The three-stage boundary-density identity follows Tallis [15]:

$$\mu_{I,j} = \frac{\sqrt{V_{I,j}}}{P_{g,m}} \sum_{\ell=1}^m r_{j\ell} B_{\ell}, \quad r_{jj} = 1. \quad (18)$$

Implementation note

The three-stage source sets one conditional correlation, $r_{13|2}$ (stages 1 and 3 with stage 2 held at its threshold), to zero instead of evaluating Eq. (17) (the two agree when no stage correlation is capped); $r_{12|3}$ and $r_{23|1}$ are evaluated properly. Some B_j terms are recomputed with the arguments of `sdutt2` in reversed order; `sdutt2` is symmetric in its two thresholds, so this is redundant but changes nothing. Apart from $r_{13|2}$, the source therefore implements Eq. (18).

For trait a , let $\mathbf{c}_a = (\text{Cov}(A_a, I_1), \dots, \text{Cov}(A_a, I_m))^T$ with $\text{Cov}(A_a, I_j) = \mathbf{b}_j^T \mathbf{G}_{j, \cdot, a}$. The source uses the nested-index covariance $V_{j\ell} = V_{I, \min(j, \ell)}$ and calculates

$$\beta_a = \mathbf{V}^{-1} \mathbf{c}_a, \quad \Delta A_{g,a} = \beta_a^T \boldsymbol{\mu}_I, \quad \Delta A_{\text{gen},a} = \frac{1}{2}(\Delta A_{s,a} + \Delta A_{d,a}). \quad (19)$$

Adding separately calculated stage gains would double-count the information shared between stages; Eq. (19) avoids that.

Implementation note

The printed multistage responses are *not* the joint-tail means themselves. Each is multiplied by $i_{\text{eff}}(P_{g,m})/i(P_{g,m})$, the ratio of the `raw13` intensity (with the final-stage sib correlations) to the ordinary intensity at the cumulative fraction, as a family-structure correction. The unadjusted means are not printed. The responses printed “after stage 1” come from a separate one-stage calculation at $P_{g,1}$ with the `raw13` intensity, and in three-stage selection those “after stage 2” from a separate two-stage calculation at $P_{g,2}$; the joint-tail means $\mu_{I,1}, \mu_{I,2}$ of the full scheme are used only inside Eq. (19).

6.3 Discrete-generation inbreeding

In words

The rate of inbreeding is predicted from how unequally the selected parents contribute genes to future generations. Parents with a high selective advantage (a high breeding value, plus good mates) have more selected offspring, and so do their offspring in turn. The equations below compute the expected long-term contributions from the selection parameters already obtained, and add a correction for the finite size of families.

The one-stage routine `sel1s` calls `dFmtblup` after its 25 rounds and after `intra_sd` (which computes the sire–dam sib correlations). Two- and three-stage selection and overlapping generations do not predict inbreeding. The arguments are the selected-parent additive covariances $\mathbf{A}_s^{\text{sel}} = 4\mathbf{A}_s$ and $\mathbf{A}_d^{\text{sel}} = 4\mathbf{A}_d$ after iteration, the EBV covariances $\mathbf{S}, \mathbf{D}$, the index weights $\mathbf{b}_s, \mathbf{b}_d$ and variances $V_{I,s}, V_{I,d}$, the fractions p_s, p_d , the six full- and half-sib index correlations, n_m, n_f and M_s, M_d . Let $d = M_d/M_s$ and let $\mathbf{\Gamma}_{gq}$ be the covariance between an information source in the sex- g index and the selective advantage of a sire ($q = s$) or dam ($q = d$), built in `create_C`:

Information source	$\mathbf{\Gamma}_{gs}$ (sire advantage)	$\mathbf{\Gamma}_{gd}$ (dam advantage)
Own performance, full-sib mean	$\frac{1}{2}\mathbf{A}_s^{\text{sel}} + \frac{1}{2d}\mathbf{A}_d^{\text{sel}}$	$\frac{1}{2}\mathbf{A}_s^{\text{sel}} + \frac{1}{2}\mathbf{A}_d^{\text{sel}}$
Dam EBV	$\mathbf{D}/d$	$\mathbf{D}$
Sire EBV	$\mathbf{S}$	$\mathbf{S}$
Half-sib mean	$\frac{1}{2}\mathbf{A}_s^{\text{sel}} + \frac{1}{2d}\mathbf{A}_d^{\text{sel}}$	$\frac{1}{2}\mathbf{A}_s^{\text{sel}}$
Mean dam EBV of half-sib group	$\mathbf{D}/d$	0
Progeny mean	$\frac{1}{4}\mathbf{A}_s^{\text{sel}} + \frac{1}{4d}\mathbf{A}_d^{\text{sel}}$	$\frac{1}{4}\mathbf{A}_s^{\text{sel}} + \frac{1}{4}\mathbf{A}_d^{\text{sel}}$

Define the variances of selective advantage

$$W_s = \mathbf{v}^\top (\mathbf{A}_s^{\text{sel}} + \mathbf{A}_d^{\text{sel}}/d) \mathbf{v}, \quad W_d = \mathbf{v}^\top (\mathbf{A}_s^{\text{sel}} + \mathbf{A}_d^{\text{sel}}) \mathbf{v}. \quad (20)$$

Two 2×2 matrices are formed from these covariance blocks:

$$\Lambda_{gq} = \frac{1}{2} \frac{i_g \mathbf{b}_g^\top \mathbf{\Gamma}_{gq} \mathbf{v}}{\sqrt{V_{I,g} W_q}}, \quad \Pi_{gq} = \frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{1}{2} - \frac{k_g \mathbf{b}_g^\top \mathbf{\Gamma}_{gq} \mathbf{v}}{W_q} \right). \quad (21)$$

With $\mathbf{h} = (1/2, 1/2)^\top$, solve $(\mathbf{I} - \Pi^\top) \mathbf{z} = \Lambda^\top \mathbf{h}$, and put $\beta_s = z_s/M_s$, $\beta_d = z_d/M_d$. With the finite-parent corrections $W'_s = (1 - 1/M_s)W_s$ and $W'_d = (1 - 1/M_s)\mathbf{v}^\top \mathbf{A}_s^{\text{sel}} \mathbf{v} + (1 - 1/M_d)\mathbf{v}^\top \mathbf{A}_d^{\text{sel}} \mathbf{v}$, the uncorrected rate of inbreeding is

$$\Delta F_0 = \frac{1}{2} \left\{ \frac{1}{4M_s} + M_s \beta_s^2 W'_s + \frac{1}{4M_d} + M_d \beta_d^2 W'_d \right\}. \quad (22)$$

Poissoncorr and **hyper_correct** add a finite-family correction. **Poissoncorr** replaces each full- or half-sib correlation ρ by $\rho - \rho(1 - \rho^2)(a/M_s + b/M_d)$, with $(a, b) = (0.8634, 0.954)$ for full sibs and $(1.4075, 1.4581)$ for half sibs. With fewer than 20 sires it also adjusts the selected fraction of the same-sex pairs of both sexes to $(1 - \rho)p + \rho \max(p, 1/M_s)$ (Bijma and Woolliams [4], Eq. 13) and recomputes i , t and k with **trunc**. Each adjusted pair gives a conditional-to-unconditional selection ratio

$$\kappa_{uv} = \frac{\Phi\{(i_u \rho_{uv} - t_v)/\sqrt{1 - k_u \rho_{uv}^2}\}}{p_v}, \quad (23)$$

using i, k of the first sex and t, p of the second. Six such ratios generate the full- and half-sib count covariance matrices in **hyper_correct**, whose correction $\frac{1}{8}(M_s \delta_s + M_d \delta_d)$ is added to Eq. (22) (Appendix C). Equation (22) alone is therefore not the displayed final rate.

Implementation note

In the $M_s < 20$ adjustment, $1/M_s$ is used for the female fraction as well as the male one, as in Eq. 13 of Bijma and Woolliams [4], where the floor represents the move towards selection between sire families when ρ is large. That paper applied the adjustment for 5 and 10 sires and, in one extreme 20-sire scheme, showed that it reduced a 37% overprediction to -13% ; it does not state a cutoff at 20 sires. The mixed (sire–dam) pairs reuse the male i, k and the female t, p obtained from the same-sex adjustments; the sire–dam correlation itself is not used to adjust a fraction. Negative variances in **hyper_correct** only print a warning.

7 Overlapping generations

In words

With overlapping generations, candidates of each sex come in K age classes. Young animals are on average genetically better, because they were produced by more recent, already improved parents. Older animals may have more information. Each age class gets its own index; then one threshold per sex is chosen so that exactly the required number of parents is selected across all classes, following truncation across cohorts [8, 11]. The share of parents coming from each age class determines the generation interval, and the response per year is the response per generation divided by that interval. Bijma, van Arendonk and Woolliams [3] also treated inbreeding under overlapping generations; the overlapping-generation driver documented here reports response but does not compute inbreeding.

7.1 Classes and selection probabilities

`ovlp` stores K sire classes (positions 1.. K) followed by K dam classes ($K + 1..2K$). Each class has candidate count $N_{g,c}$, selected count $n_{g,c}$, fraction $p_{g,c} = n_{g,c}/N_{g,c}$, index variance $V_{I,g,c}$, and the quantities of Eq. (10). The youngest class is not an input: $N_{s,1} = M_d n_m$ and $N_{d,1} = M_d n_f$. Two modes exist. In *specified-count* mode, the $n_{g,c}$ are inputs. In *threshold* (truncation) mode, a common threshold x_g solves

$$n_{g,c} = N_{g,c} \bar{\Phi} \left(\frac{x_g - m_{g,c}}{\sqrt{V_{I,g,c}}} \right), \quad m_{g,c} = -(c-1) \Delta H_g^{\text{year}}, \quad \sum_c n_{s,c} = M_s, \quad \sum_c n_{d,c} = M_d. \quad (24)$$

Here $m_{g,c}$ is the mean index of class c relative to the youngest class: each older class is one more cohort interval of genetic progress behind (Figure 6). ΔH_g^{year} is the response per cohort interval (“per year”) along the path of sex g (Eq. (26)), taken from the previous round.

Overlapping generations: one threshold is applied to all age classes

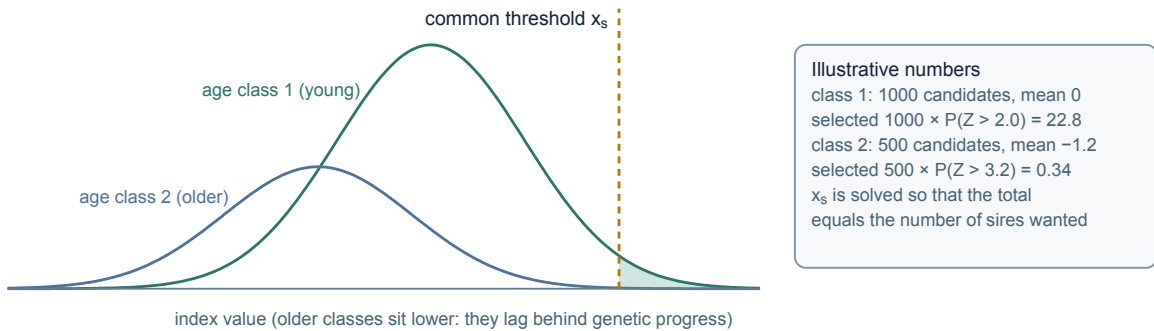


Figure 6: One threshold applied to two age classes of sires (illustrative numbers). The older class lags behind and contributes few selected animals even though it is large. Editable SVG source: `selection_agethreshold.svg`.

`trunc_delta` evaluates each class with the exact normal upper tail ($\bar{\Phi}$, computed by `sdutt1` via the Fortran `erfc` intrinsic), and `riddr_root` (Ridders’ method) solves the count equation. Threshold mode starts from a uniform fraction $p = M_s / \sum_c N_{s,c}$ (and likewise for dams). Classes

without information sources get $p = 0$; in threshold mode a class without new information inherits the sources of the previous class.

Implementation note

The search interval for x_g is the union of $m_{g,c} \pm 8\sqrt{V_{I,g,c}}$ over classes, extended to include 0. At 8 index standard deviations essentially no animals are selected, so any feasible target is bracketed. `trunc_delta` also stores the class fractions as a side effect, so it is re-evaluated at the root after `riddr_root` returns. The original code approximated $\bar{\Phi}$ by Gauss–Hermite quadrature (inaccurate beyond about 4 standard deviations), clipped standardised thresholds to $[-3, 3]$, and searched only ± 1.5 standard deviations; together these forced at least 6.7% of the youngest class and 0.135% of every class to be selected (see `NEWS.md`).

Each age class has its own index and selected fraction

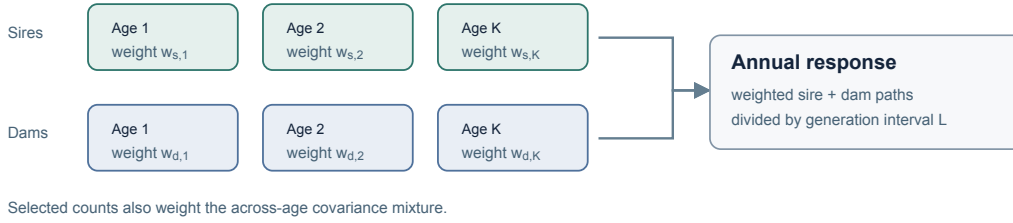


Figure 7: Selected age classes determine each parental path, the generation interval, and the covariance mixture. Editable SVG source: `selection_ages.svg`.

7.2 Generation interval and annual response

Set $N_g^* = \sum_c n_{g,c}$ and $w_{g,c} = n_{g,c}/N_g^*$ (Figure 7). The generation interval, in the program’s age-class units (“cohort intervals”), with the youngest class at age 1, is

$$L_s = \sum_c c w_{s,c}, \quad L_d = \sum_c c w_{d,c}, \quad L = (L_s + L_d)/2. \quad (25)$$

For every active class, $\mathbf{P}_x, \mathbf{G}, \mathbf{b}, V_I$ are built with Eq. (7). Let $\mu_{g,c,a} = i_{g,c} q_{g,c,a} / \sqrt{V_{I,g,c}}$ be the mean breeding value for trait a of the animals selected from class c , where $q_{g,c,a}$ is component a of $\mathbf{G}_{g,c}^\top \mathbf{b}_{g,c}$ and $i_{g,c}$ is the ordinary truncation intensity of that class. The response per year along the path of sex g , and the overall response per year, are

$$\Delta A_{g,a}^{\text{year}} = \frac{1}{L} \sum_c w_{g,c} \mu_{g,c,a}, \quad \Delta H_g^{\text{year}} = \frac{1}{L} \sum_c w_{g,c} i_{g,c} \sqrt{V_{I,g,c}}, \quad (26)$$

$$\Delta A_a^{\text{year}} = \frac{1}{2} (\Delta A_{s,a}^{\text{year}} + \Delta A_{d,a}^{\text{year}}), \quad \Delta H^{\text{year}} = \frac{1}{2} (\Delta H_s^{\text{year}} + \Delta H_d^{\text{year}}). \quad (27)$$

The “sires” and “dams” columns of the output show $\frac{1}{2} \Delta A_{g,a}^{\text{year}}$, so that they add up to the total. No gene-flow transition matrix is assembled.

Implementation note

Intensity. `selection_index` still evaluates `rawl3` for every class, but `ovlp` discards that result and recomputes the responses with the ordinary intensity $i_{g,c}$ from `trunc`: overlapping-generation responses are not corrected for family structure.

Generation interval. When the code was adapted to current compilers (in an earlier fork, `fortran_linux/`, since removed), a renamed variable turned the accumulation in Eq. (25) into an assignment, so the sum was replaced by the last active class's term, added to a stale value of the interval left by `trunc_delta` in threshold mode. The original source (`fortran_orig/selovlp.f90`) accumulates correctly. The error is fixed in `fortran/`; before and after values are in `NEWS.md`. The printed interval is rounded to two decimals.

No phenotypic information. If, in some age class, a trait in the index or goal has no phenotypic source and no genetic correlation with a trait that has one (for example BLUP as the only source), its genetic variance goes to zero. `ovlp` then prints a warning naming the trait and classes, and continues; the discrete drivers instead stop and ask for other sources or correlations.

7.3 Age-specific covariance update

Each active class receives its own rank-one family-covariance update by `ovlp_cov_update`, the same as Eq. (12). The across-class mixture follows the idea of accounting for within-class variances and genetic differences between parental age classes in deterministic breeding models [11]. The source then computes the lag of each class behind the path average, $\ell_{g,c,a} = \mu_{g,c,a} - c \Delta A_{g,a}^{\text{year}}$, and the path mean $\bar{\ell}_{g,a} = \sum_c w_{g,c} \ell_{g,c,a}$. Its across-class update is a law-of-total-covariance mixture: the covariance within classes plus the covariance between class means,

$$\begin{aligned} (A_g^{\text{family}})_{ab} &= \sum_c w_{g,c} \left[(A_{g,c}^{\text{family}})_{ab} + \frac{1}{4} (\ell_{g,c,a} - \bar{\ell}_{g,a}) (\ell_{g,c,b} - \bar{\ell}_{g,b}) \right], \\ (S_g)_{ab} &= \sum_c w_{g,c} \left[(S_{g,c})_{ab} + (\ell_{g,c,a} - \bar{\ell}_{g,a}) (\ell_{g,c,b} - \bar{\ell}_{g,b}) \right]. \end{aligned} \quad (28)$$

Sire classes are mixed only with sire classes, and dam classes with dam classes. The mixed matrices are copied into all age classes and the cycle is repeated 25 times; in threshold mode the fractions, intensities, generation interval and selected numbers are re-solved at the end of every round.

Implementation note

The phenotypic matrix of each class is rebuilt as $\mathbf{P} = \mathbf{A} + \mathbf{C} + \mathbf{E}$ using the $\mathbf{A}$ of the *previous* round, while the stored $\mathbf{A}$ is updated in the same step; $\mathbf{P}$ therefore lags $\mathbf{A}$ by one round (in discrete generations both are updated together). The effect vanishes at convergence but matters for a bitwise port. Because responses are computed before the end-of-round threshold update, the printed fractions and generation interval are one update ahead of the printed responses.

8 Source map and numerical contract

Source routine	Mathematical responsibility
<code>sel1s, sel2s, sel3s</code>	Discrete input, iteration, and one- to three-stage outputs; Eqs. (9), (14), (19).
<code>info_sources*</code>	Ordered list of trait–source pairs, including the BLUP expansion (Section 4.2).
<code>selection_index</code>	Source covariance table, $\mathbf{P}_x$, $\mathbf{G}$, $\mathbf{b}$, family correlations, and the <code>rawl3</code> -based response; Eqs. (6), (7)–(11).
<code>covariance_update</code>	Rank-one family and EBV updates and reassembly; Eqs. (12), (5).
<code>ovlp_cov_update</code>	Rank-one update per age class only; the mixture and reassembly are in <code>ovlp</code> ; Eqs. (12), (28).
<code>trunc, gcef</code>	Normal truncation i, k and approximate Φ^{-1} ; Eq. (10).
<code>rawl3, sintvi</code>	Family-adjusted and finite-population intensity; Appendix B.
<code>sseuil*, sdutt, sdutt1, sdutt2</code>	Joint-normal thresholds and tails; Eqs. (14)–(18).
<code>ovlp, trunc_delta, riddr_root</code>	Age counts, generation interval, annual response and mixture; Eqs. (24)–(28).
<code>dFmtblup, create_C, Poissoncorr, hyper_correct</code>	Discrete inbreeding; Eqs. (20)–(23) and Appendix C.

For a reproducible port, preserve: the order of sources (sorted) and goal traits; separate sire/dam and stage-specific source lists; group sizes; selection fractions; the 25-round update order (including the one-round lag of $\mathbf{P}$ under overlapping generations); the 0.93 cap on stage correlations and the $[-1, 1]$ clip on family correlations; exact normal tails (`sdutt1`) and the ± 8 standard-deviation bracket; and the `gcef/sintvi` approximations. Use double precision for joint tails, as the source does. Compare index weights and per-trait responses against the Fortran, not just aggregate gain: a transposed covariance block can hide in the latter.

9 Known issues and open questions

In words

These are places where the code is known or suspected to differ from the intended model. Their effect on results is small or not yet quantified; several are questions for the original authors (Section 9.1). Fixes made so far and their effects are recorded in `NEWS.md`.

1. **One-round lag of $\mathbf{P}$ behind $\mathbf{A}$** under overlapping generations. Negligible at convergence.
2. $r_{13|2} = 0$ in three-stage selection instead of Eq. (17), and the empirical 0.93 cap on stage correlations (Eq. (13)). With nested optimal indices, the zero partial correlation follows from the uncapped accuracy ratios; the cap can invalidate it.
3. **Overlapping-generation family correction.** The original program description (`manual_orig/`, Program Description) says that intensity is adjusted for family structure in each sex-age class, but `ovlp` uses ordinary truncation intensity in the response.
4. **Earlier-stage source lists with $M_s = M_d$.** Half-sib sources are removed only from the

final-stage source list (Section 4.2); earlier-stage indices of two- and three-stage selection keep them if they were entered.

5. **Symmetric-block assumption.** When filling $\mathbf{P}_x$ the source mirrors blocks without transposing trait indices (Appendix A), which is exact only for symmetric blocks. $\mathbf{S}$ and $\mathbf{D}$ start non-symmetric when heritabilities differ, but the asymmetry decays to rounding level well before round 25 and has no effect on printed output.
6. **Hard switch at 20 sires.** At $M_s = 20$ the selected-fraction adjustment in `Poissoncorr` is switched off and the β terms of Eq. (36) are switched on, so predicted ΔF jumps (4.590% to 4.682% from 19 to 20 sires in one example). The $1/M_s$ floor itself follows Bijma and Woolliams [4], Eq. 13.
7. **Per-sex lag between age classes.** The class means in the threshold search (Eq. (24)) and the lags in the covariance mixture (Eq. (28)) use each sex’s own path response per year rather than the population gain. The effect was below 1% of response in our examples.
8. **Unused duplicate of the inbreeding code.** `sell1s` calls the `dFmtblup` in `selroutines.f90`. A second copy in `selinbreeding.f90` was compiled but never called; it was removed from `fortran/` on 5 October 2026 and remains only in `fortran_orig/`. It contains two defects: its first two `trunc` calls use positional arguments, so the intensity receives the normal ordinate z , k receives the intensity, and k itself is never computed; and a 0 entry in a source list stops the program. It should not be switched in without fixing these.

9.1 Questions for the original authors

These points need the intent of the original model before the code is changed. They are also listed, with source locations, in `NEWS.md`.

1. **Generation interval.** The original source, and the corrected fork, use Eq. (25): age classes numbered from 1, weighted by the numbers selected, and the average of the two sexes dividing both paths’ responses. Does the numbering represent actual parental ages, with the youngest class at age 1 and each class one cohort interval older? If age at first offspring differs from one cohort interval, should users account for it outside `SelAction`?
2. **Finite-family correction.** The adjustment of the selected fraction uses $1/M_s$ for both sexes, as in Eq. 13 of Bijma and Woolliams [4]. What motivated switching it off at $M_s = 20$, the same point at which the β terms of Eq. (36) are switched on? In one example ΔF rises from 4.590% at 19 sires to 4.682% at 20. Is reusing the male i, k and female t, p for the sire–dam pairs intended?
3. **Three-stage selection.** With nested optimal indices the ratio of accuracies is the exact stage correlation, and $r_{13|2} = 0$ follows from it; when the 0.93 cap (Eq. (13)) binds this no longer holds. Was the cap introduced for the numerical integration, and should $r_{13|2}$ be computed from Eq. (17) so that it stays correct when the cap binds?
4. **Mating ratio 1.** Should half-sib sources also be removed from earlier-stage indices when $M_s = M_d$?
5. **Family structure under overlapping generations.** The original program description says intensities are adjusted for family structure in each sex-age class, but `ovlp` discards the `raw13` result. Was the correction intended to enter the overlapping-generation response, and how should it be applied with a common truncation point?

6. **Genetic lag between age classes.** Eq. (24) and the lags in Eq. (28) use each sex’s own path response per year. Should both sexes use the population gain (per trait, $\frac{1}{2}(\Delta A_{s,a}^{\text{year}} + \Delta A_{d,a}^{\text{year}})$), since candidates born in the same year share the same parents?
7. **Overlapping-generation search.** The former ± 1.5 standard-deviation search bracket and ± 3 standard-deviation clamp were removed (Section 7); with them gone, breeding-goal variance and accuracy fall steadily with selection intensity as the Bulmer effect predicts. Were they deliberate, and does the new behaviour match expectations?

References

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A Remaining information-source covariance blocks

These are the remaining $\mathbf{P}_x$ rules from `selection_index`. Each entry is a $T \times T$ block; rows for unused sources are dropped afterwards. Write O for own phenotype, B_d, B_s for dam and sire EBV, F_u for a full-sib mean, J_u for a paternal-half-sib mean, $\bar{B}_u$ for the mean dam EBV of half-sib group u , and Q_u for a progeny mean. Group-diagonal blocks for F_u, J_u, Q_u are in Eq. (6).

Source pair	Covariance block
$O, O; O, B_d; O, B_s$	$\mathbf{P}; \mathbf{D}/2; \mathbf{S}/2$
$B_d, B_d; B_d, B_s; B_s, B_s$	$\mathbf{D}; 0; \mathbf{S}$
$O, F_u; O, J_u; O, \bar{B}_u; O, Q_u$	$\mathbf{F}; \mathbf{J}; 0; \mathbf{A}/2$
$B_d, F_u; B_d, J_u; B_d, \bar{B}_u; B_d, Q_u$	$\mathbf{D}/2; 0; 0; \mathbf{D}/4$
$B_s, F_u; B_s, J_u; B_s, \bar{B}_u; B_s, Q_u$	$\mathbf{S}/2; \mathbf{S}/2; 0; \mathbf{S}/4$
$F_u, F_v; F_u, J_v; F_u, \bar{B}_v; F_u, Q_v$	$\mathbf{F}; \mathbf{J}; 0; (\mathbf{A}_s + \mathbf{A}_d)/2$
$J_u, J_v; J_u, \bar{B}_v; J_u, Q_v$	$\mathbf{J}; 0; \mathbf{J}/2$
$\bar{B}_u, \bar{B}_v; \bar{B}_u, Q_v$	$0; 0$
Q_u, Q_v	$\mathbf{A}/4$ for a sire candidate; $\mathbf{A}/2$ for a dam candidate

For pairs of the *same* type ($F_u, F_v; J_u, J_v; \bar{B}_u, \bar{B}_v; Q_u, Q_v$) the table gives $u \neq v$; the same-group values are in Eq. (6) and, for the half-sib group, $\text{Var}(\bar{B}_u) = \mathbf{D}/m_{H,u}$ and $\text{Cov}(J_u, \bar{B}_u) = \mathbf{D}/(2m_{H,u})$. For pairs of *different* types, the listed value is used for every u, v , including $u = v$, except $\text{Cov}(J_u, \bar{B}_u)$ just given. Same-group values apply only to configured groups; unused group slots take the $u \neq v$ value and are dropped anyway. These rules include zeros fixed by the source, even where a fuller pedigree model would give a nonzero covariance.

Implementation note

The source fills the lower triangle of the source-by-source table by copying blocks with the source indices swapped but the trait indices unchanged. This is correct only when the block is symmetric. A port should use $\text{Cov}(x_{a,j}, x_{b,i}) = \text{block}(i, j)_{ba}$. The same-source blocks **D**, **S** and **D**/ $m_{H,u}$ make **P**_x non-symmetric by themselves whenever **S**, **D** are; a port should symmetrise **S** and **D** or confirm they are symmetric; the update of Eq. (12) gives symmetric matrices in exact arithmetic, but the simplified starting values (Section 5.3) need not be.

B Family-adjusted intensity approximation

Let $n = \text{nint}(n_w n_{fs} n_{hs})$ (rounded, used in every $n - 1$ below), $n_{\text{sel}} = p n_w n_{fs} n_{hs}$ (not rounded), and $I_N(p) = \text{sintvi}(p, N)$, the finite-candidate intensity approximation. **raw13** forms three reference intensities: $i_a = I_n(p)$ for unrelated candidates, i_b for perfectly correlated members within each full-sib family, and i_c for a perfectly correlated paternal half-sib family. For i_b , take family size $h = n_w$ and family count $N = n_{fs} n_{hs}$; for i_c , take $h = n_w n_{fs}$ and $N = n_{hs}$. With $r = \text{mod}(n_{\text{sel}}, h)$ and $a = \text{nint}((n_{\text{sel}} - r)/h) + 1$, the source's reference calculation is

$$I_{\text{family}}(h, N) = \begin{cases} I_{\text{nint}(N)}(1/N), & r = n_{\text{sel}}, \\ \frac{I_{\text{nint}(N)}((a-1)/N) (a-1)(h-r) + I_{\text{nint}(N)}(a/N) ar}{n_{\text{sel}}}, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases} \quad (29)$$

For real-valued family sizes (the mating ratio d need not be an integer) the **mod**/**nint** conventions matter. Define

$$f(x) = 0.63e^{3.36(x-1)} + 0.37e^{86(x-1)}. \quad (30)$$

If $n_w = n_{fs} = 1$, $i_{\text{eff}} = i_a$. If $n_{fs} = 1$, the family branch is

$$b_1 = \frac{\log i_c - \log i_a}{\log\{1 - (n_w - 1)/(n - 1)\}}, \quad b = \frac{1}{2}\{1 - f(\rho_{fs})\} + b_1 f(\rho_{fs}), \quad i_{\text{eff}} = i_a \{1 - \rho_{fs}(n_w - 1)/(n - 1)\}^b. \quad (31)$$

If $n_w = 1$, replace n_w by n_{fs} and ρ_{fs} by ρ_{hs} in Eq. (31). If $n_{hs} = 1$, use Eq. (31) with i_b in place of i_c and $\rho_{fs} - \rho_{hs}$ in place of ρ_{fs} , then multiply the result by $\sqrt{1 - \rho_{hs}}$. (The equality tests use a tolerance of 10^{-4} .)

For the general branch define

$$\begin{aligned} \rho_a &= \frac{(n_w - 1)\rho_{fs} + (n_{fs} - 1)n_w \rho_{hs}}{n - 1}, & \rho_{bc} &= \frac{(n_w - 1) + (n_{fs} - 1)n_w \rho_{hs}}{n - 1}, \\ \rho_{bc2} &= \frac{\rho_{hs}(n_{fs} - 1)}{n_{fs} n_{hs} - 1}, & \rho_c &= \frac{(n_w - 1) + (n_{fs} - 1)n_w}{n - 1}, & \rho_{c2} &= \frac{n_{fs} - 1}{n_{fs} n_{hs} - 1}. \end{aligned} \quad (32)$$

The interpolation is

$$\begin{aligned} a_c &= \frac{\log i_c - \log i_a}{\log(1 - \rho_c)}, & b_c &= \frac{\log i_c - \log i_b}{\log(1 - \rho_{c2})}, & y_h &= f(\rho_{hs}), \\ b_0 &= \frac{1}{2}(1 - y_h) + a_c y_h, & i_{bc} &= i_b(1 - \rho_{bc2})^{\frac{1}{2}(1 - y_h) + b_c y_h}, & b_{bc} &= \frac{\log i_{bc} - \log i_a}{\log(1 - \rho_{bc})}, \\ b_a &= \frac{b_0 - b_{bc} y_h}{1 - y_h}, & b &= b_a \{1 - f(\rho_{fs})\} + b_{bc} f(\rho_{fs}), & i_{\text{eff}} &= i_a(1 - \rho_a)^b. \end{aligned} \quad (33)$$

When $|1 - y_h| < 10^{-6}$ the source sets $b_a = b_{bc}$ to avoid an indeterminate division.

`sintvi` is a numerical approximation, not further population genetics: it raises p to at least $1/N$, returns 0 for $p \geq 1$, uses Falconer's tabulated intensities with linear interpolation for $p < 0.001$ and Brascamp's polynomial in $\log(1/p - 1)$ otherwise, and applies the finite-population correction $i - (1/p - 1)/\{(2N + 2)i\}$ (both skipped when $N = 0$).

C Finite-family inbreeding correction

Denote the six selection ratios from Eq. (23) by full-sib values $\kappa_{ss}^F, \kappa_{sd}^F, \kappa_{dd}^F$ and half-sib values $\kappa_{ss}^J, \kappa_{sd}^J, \kappa_{dd}^J$. With n_m, n_f male and female candidates per dam, M_s, M_d selected parents, and $T_m = n_m M_d, T_f = n_f M_d$ the numbers of male and female candidates, `hyper_correct` forms

$$\begin{aligned} (V_F)_{11} &= \frac{n_m(n_m - 1)M_s(M_s - 1)\kappa_{ss}^F}{T_m(T_m - 1)}, & (V_F)_{12} &= \frac{n_m n_f M_s M_d \kappa_{sd}^F}{T_m T_f}, \\ (V_F)_{22} &= \frac{n_f(n_f - 1)M_d(M_d - 1)\kappa_{dd}^F}{T_f(T_f - 1)}, & (V_J)_{11} &= \frac{n_m^2 M_s(M_s - 1)\kappa_{ss}^J}{T_m(T_m - 1)}, \\ (V_J)_{12} &= \frac{n_m n_f M_s M_d \kappa_{sd}^J}{T_m T_f}, & (V_J)_{22} &= \frac{n_f^2 M_d(M_d - 1)\kappa_{dd}^J}{T_f(T_f - 1)}. \end{aligned} \quad (34)$$

Both matrices are symmetric. The source sets $V_s = dV_F + d(d - 1)V_J$ and $V_d = V_F$, then subtracts squared conditional-mean matrices. With W'_s, W'_d from Section 6.3 and $\lambda_{gq} = \Lambda_{gq}$ from Eq. (21), these are

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{M}_s &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 + 4\lambda_{ss}^2 W'_s & d(1 + 4\lambda_{ss}\lambda_{ds} W'_s) \\ d(1 + 4\lambda_{ss}\lambda_{ds} W'_s) & d^2(1 + 4\lambda_{ds}^2 W'_s) \end{pmatrix}, \\ \mathbf{M}_d &= \begin{pmatrix} (1 + 4\lambda_{sd}^2 W'_d)/d^2 & (1 + 4\lambda_{sd}\lambda_{dd} W'_d)/d \\ (1 + 4\lambda_{sd}\lambda_{dd} W'_d)/d & 1 + 4\lambda_{dd}^2 W'_d \end{pmatrix}. \end{aligned} \quad (35)$$

After the subtraction, keep the names V_s, V_d and let $\boldsymbol{\alpha} = (1/(2M_s), 1/(2M_d))^T$. Set $\delta_q = \boldsymbol{\alpha}^T V_q \boldsymbol{\alpha}$. For $M_s > 19$ (the same boundary at which the selected-fraction adjustment of `Poissoncorr` is switched off; Section 9), also calculate

$$\delta_s \leftarrow \delta_s + W'_s \mathbf{t}_s^T V_s \mathbf{t}_s, \quad \delta_d \leftarrow \delta_d + W'_d \mathbf{t}_d^T V_d \mathbf{t}_d, \quad \mathbf{t}_q = (\beta_s(2\Pi_{sq}), \beta_d(2\Pi_{dq}))^T. \quad (36)$$

The final predicted rate, printed as a percentage, is

$$\Delta F = \Delta F_0 + \frac{1}{8}(M_s \delta_s + M_d \delta_d). \quad (37)$$

The `dFmtblup` that is called is the copy in `selroutines.f90`; its `trunc` calls use named arguments for intensity and k . The copy in `selinbreeding.f90` was never called and is now only in `fortran_orig/` (Section 9).